

Seriously, how bad is AI to the environment?

Posted by u/Education-Sea • 0 points • 8 comments

Those that participate in the Anti-AI movement commonly complain that AI is very bad to the environment, that it takes a lot of energy and water. I have seen some users here disputing those claims. I'm not anti-AI, so I'd like to read some articles that are unbiased about the subject, and share them with certain luddites.

Comments

u/Kitchen-Jicama8715 • 1 points • 2025-11-16 15:59 UTC

AI does have a legit environmental footprint (energy, water, hardware, etc.), and companies should be way more transparent about it, but it's definitely ****not the first thing on the chopping block**** if we're trying to reduce digital emissions. If we're prioritising, streaming video platforms, always-on adtech, crypto mining, and general consumer device churn burn through far more energy globally than people asking a chatbot questions. AI needs smarter scaling, renewable-powered data centers, and better reporting, but acting like shutting down ChatGPT is going to save the planet while everyone keeps bingeing 4K Netflix and doomscrolling TikTok all night is basically vibes-based policymaking, not environmental strategy.

u/Calculus • 1 points • 2025-11-16 15:57 UTC

If you're pushing this argument but aren't a vegetarian living off the grid you're full of hypocritical shit.

u/Mighty-anemone • 2 points • 2025-11-16 15:49 UTC

Not sure who down voted you for asking a good faith question in a respectful manner. Have an upvote on me :-)

It's something I need to research in depth myself so I'll be following this thread for some leads.

u/Serialbedshitter2322 • 4 points • 2025-11-16 15:32 UTC

It doesn't really take that much to discredit their ideas. AI is basically nothing in comparison to anything else, like a single hamburger outweighs multiple avid chatgpt users

u/Education-Sea • 2 points • 2025-11-16 15:42 UTC

I have heard the hamburger claim before. Is there any article that talks about this?

I'm not asking because I don't believe you, but because a source would help in online debates.

u/Serialbedshitter2322 • 1 points • 2025-11-16 15:54 UTC

Perhaps an article isn't the way to go, for one most of them aren't gonna want to read a long article, but also most of them will also include information that they can use to refute it like the potential growth of AI datacenters, it would just muddy up the argument. You can ask ChatGPT to find you an article pretty fast though. When I make these arguments I get ChatGPT to tell me the exact environmental impact with a credible source of hamburgers and AI separately, then I compare the numbers for them. Even if you bring video and image AI into the equation it usually still doesn't compare.

u/Economy-Fee5830 • 2 points • 2025-11-16 15:46 UTC

Ask chatgpt

>!badum tss!<

u/United-Advisor-5910 • -1 points • 2025-11-16 15:31 UTC

It's AI it's what drives AI at the present moment. Re nuclear able fusion to the rescue in the next decade. Also china's setting the bar right now